

Bones and muscles

You would be like a lump of jelly without your skeleton – a frame of bones that holds you up and protects your internal organs.

Bending backbone

Your backbone contains 24 small bones called vertebrae. They move almost every time you do.

The vertebrae in your back allow you to twist and bend.

Head case

The bones that make up your skull join after you are born.

The skull has two parts – the lower jaw and cranium.

Only your jaw can move.

Bone marrow supplies your body with red blood cells.

Brilliant bone

Bones have a clever structure that makes them light but strong. They can heal themselves if broken.

The honeycomb structure of some bone makes it weigh less than if it were solid.

Snake ribcages can run almost the entire length of their bodies.

Skull

Ribcage

Backbone

The **wrist** is made up of eight small bones.

Cranium

Lower jaw

The **hip** is a ball and socket joint, allowing the legs to move around.

Both the **knee** and **elbow** are hinged joints that only move in one direction.

Ribcage

A ribcage has long, curved bones that protect vital organs such as the heart and lungs.